

Alexandra Dones
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Assignment 2

Assignment Overview:

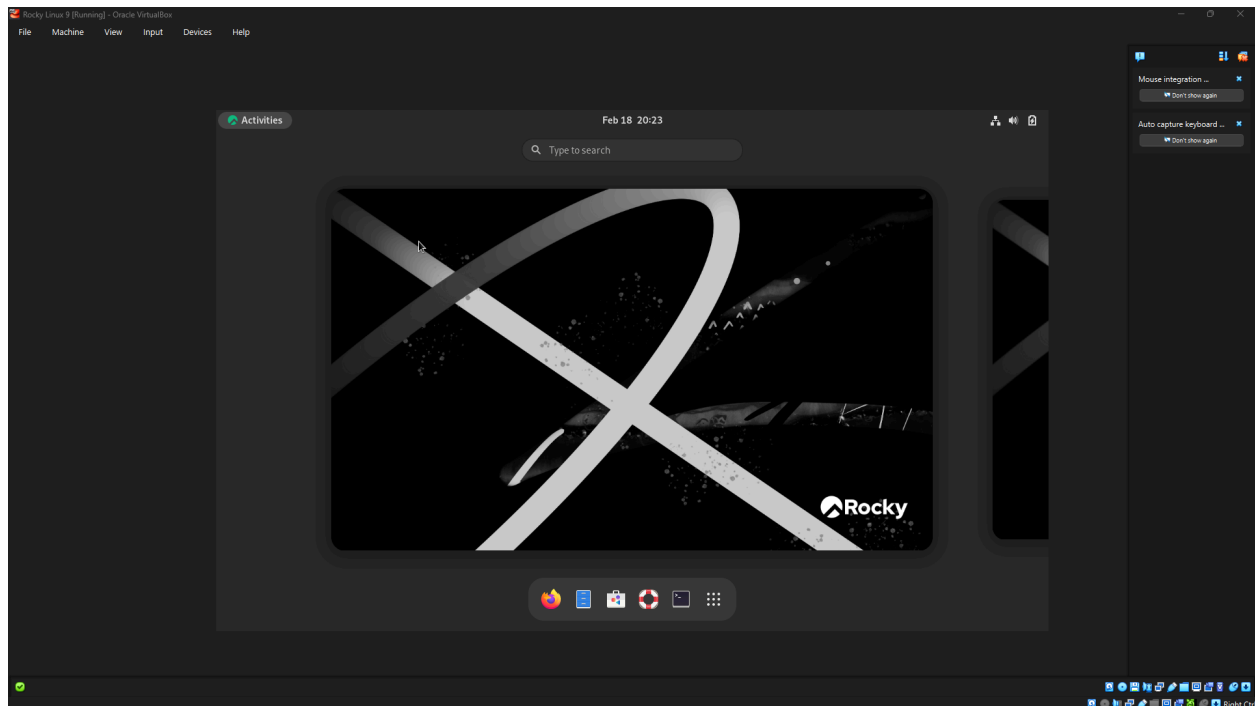
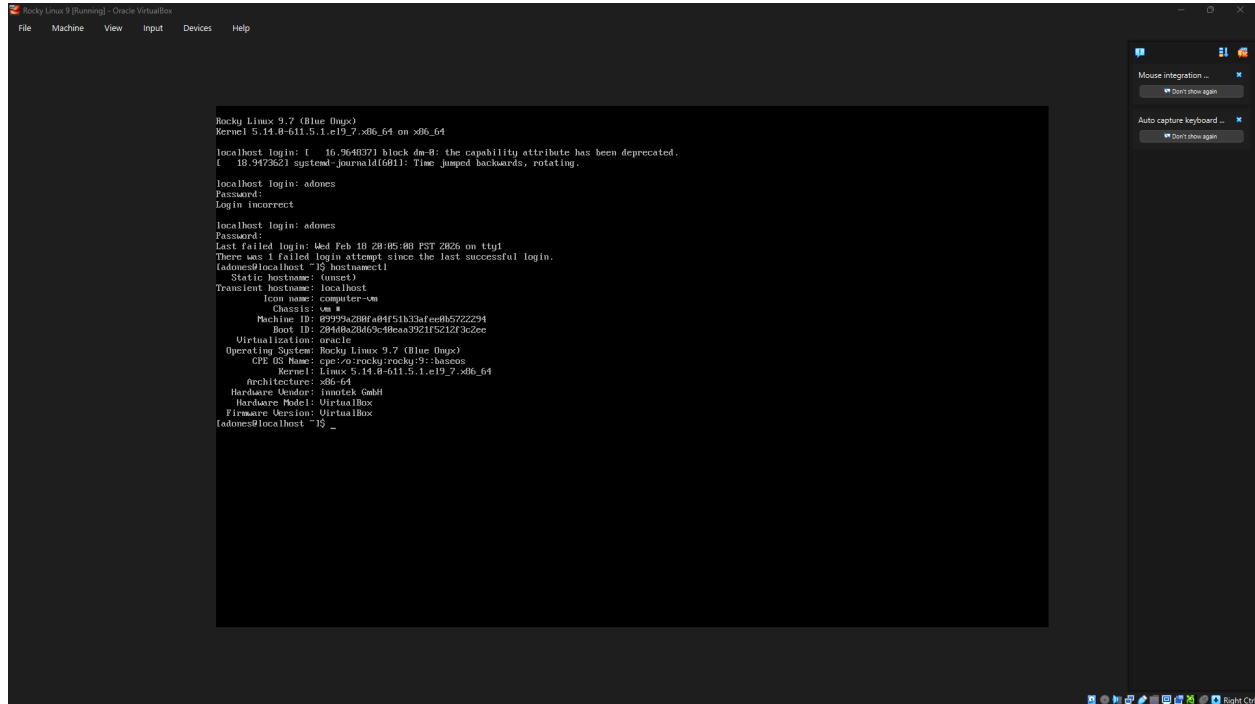
The goal of this assignment is to create two virtual machines. This task involves researching/evaluating Linux distributions to select one distribution (distro) for use with a virtual machine (VM). The final deliverable will be a report including screenshots of your VMs created with justification for the chosen Linux distro. Further details are included below.

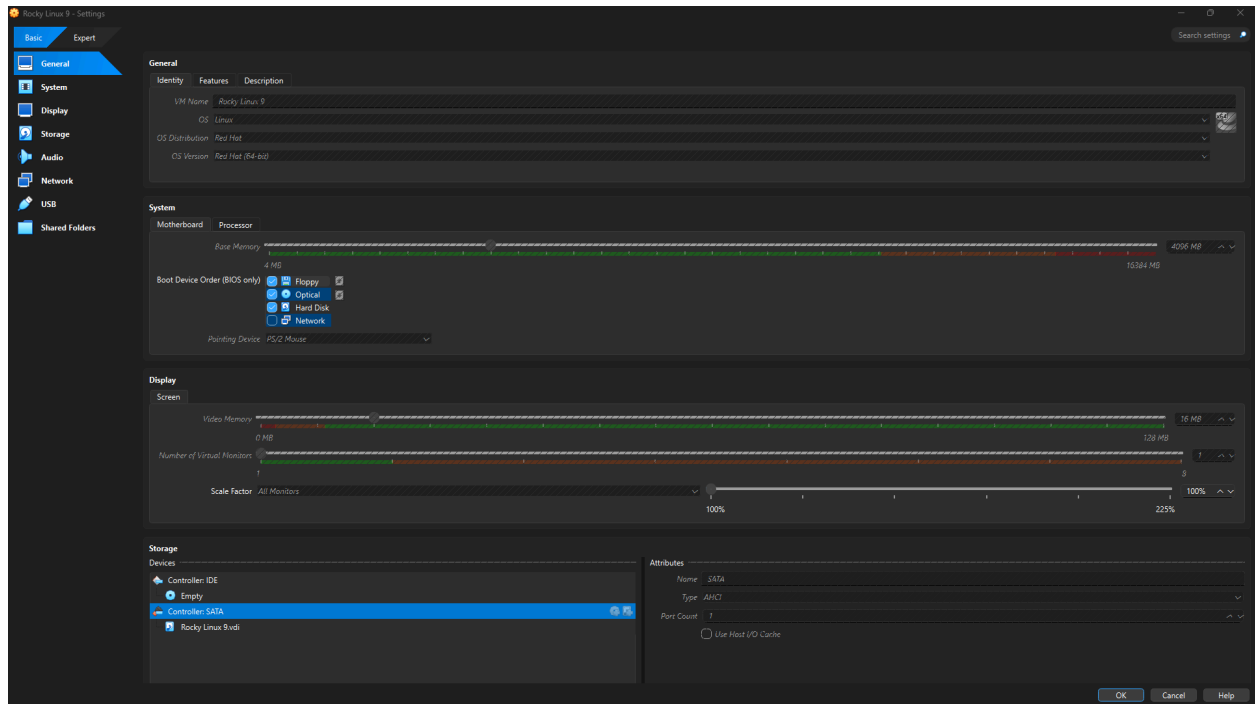
Main Tasks:

This assignment will encompass the following tasks:

1. Research and identify Linux distributions
2. Select your distribution based on your own set of evaluation criteria. Criteria may include:
 - Performance and resource consumption
 - Support/compatibility with tools and libraries
 - Ease of setup and maintenance
 - Compatibility with the target virtual machine platform
 - Availability of software and packages
 - Community and commercial support options
 - Documentation quality
3. Create a virtual machine using your selected Linux distribution and write a report summarizing your rationale for selecting the Linux distribution.
4. Create a second virtual machine for one of the following operating systems.
(Windows 10/11 or Rocky Linux 9)

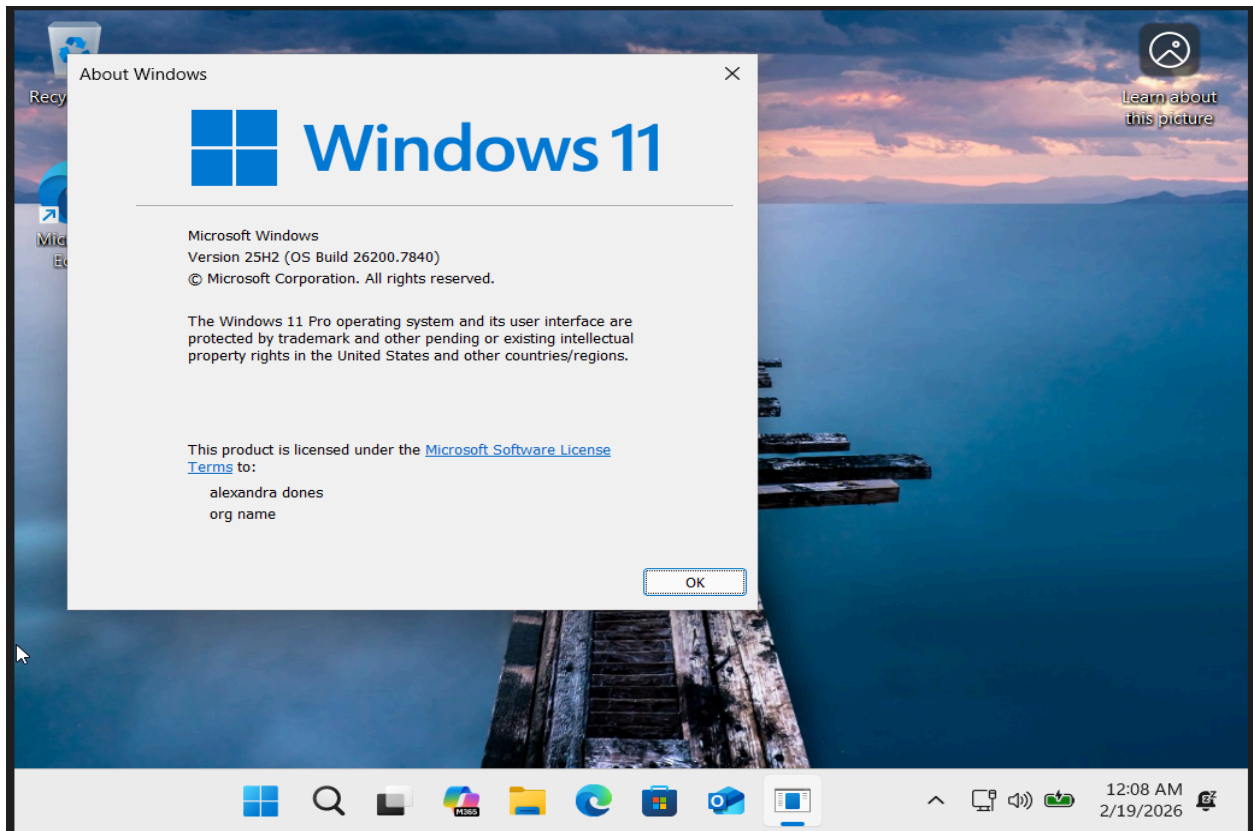
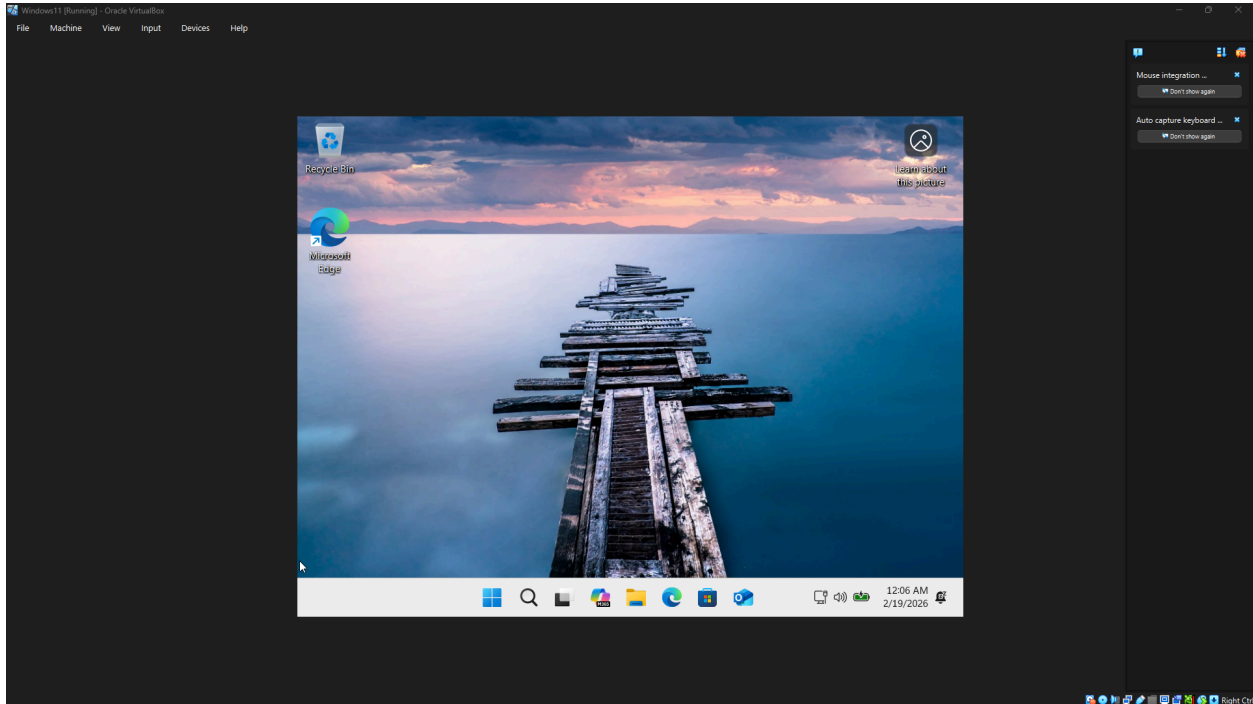
Rocky Linux 9

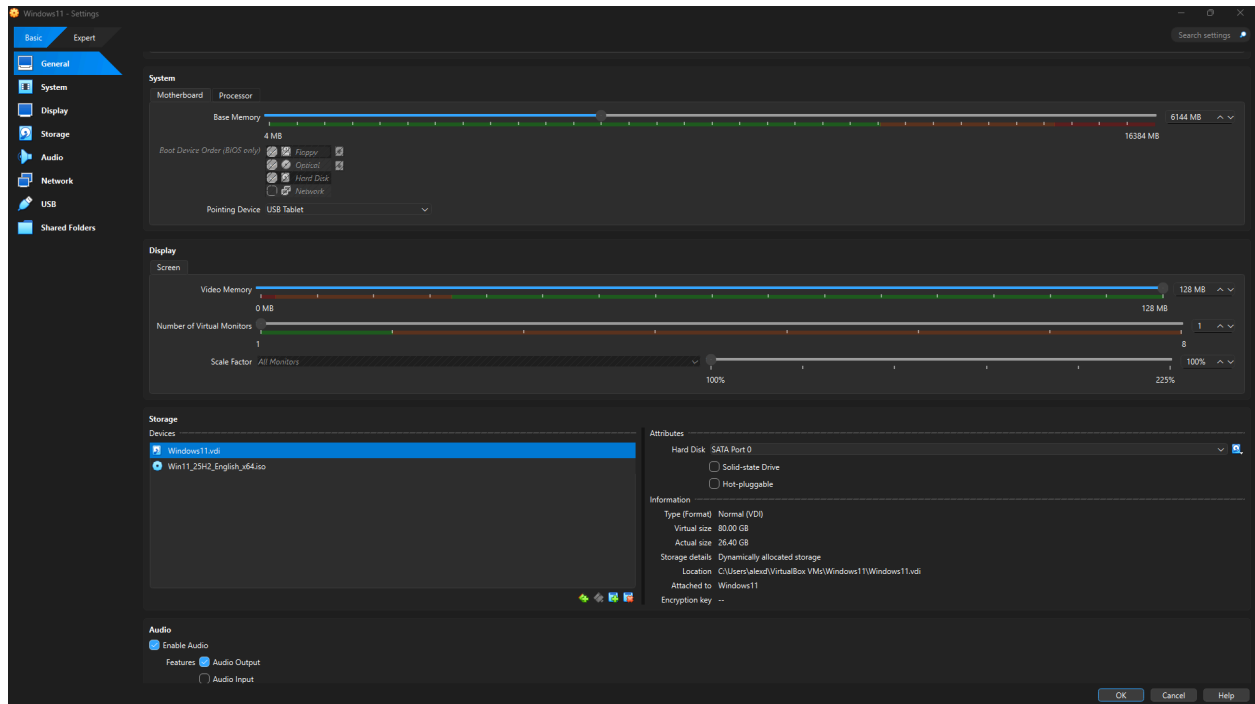




For this assignment, I selected Rocky Linux 9 as my Linux distribution because it offers enterprise-level stability, strong performance, and compatibility with professional tools. Based on the system information gathered earlier, my computer has 16GB of RAM installed but only around 2–3GB available during normal use, so resource efficiency was an important factor in my decision. To reduce unnecessary background services and improve performance inside the virtual machine, I chose the Rocky Linux 9 Minimal ISO (approximately 2.3GB) instead of the larger DVD version. After completing the minimal installation, I manually installed the GNOME graphical user interface to maintain usability while keeping the base system lightweight. This approach allowed me to balance performance, ease of setup, and functionality while ensuring the virtual machine runs smoothly in VirtualBox.

Windows 11





For my second virtual machine, I selected Windows 11 instead of Windows 10. I chose Windows 11 because it is the operating system currently running on my host machine, which makes it more familiar and relevant to my everyday use. Using the same version of Windows also allows me to better understand compatibility between host and guest systems while maintaining consistency in features and interface. The Windows 11 virtual machine was created using Oracle VirtualBox. I configured the VM with 6GB of RAM, 2 CPU cores, and an 80GB dynamically allocated virtual hard disk to ensure stable performance while avoiding excessive resource usage on the host system. I enabled EFI and TPM 2.0 support, which are required for Windows 11 installation. The operating system was installed successfully using the official Windows 11 ISO file. Overall, Windows 11 was selected due to familiarity, compatibility with modern software, and its relevance as the current mainstream Microsoft operating system. The virtual machine runs smoothly within VirtualBox and provides a functional Windows environment for testing and further assignments.